

Voluntary Report – Voluntary - Public Distribution

Date: March 11, 2025

Report Number: CB2025-0003

Report Name: Cambodia Soy Bean Meal and Dried Distillers Grains Market Brief

Country: Cambodia

Post: Ho Chi Minh City

Report Category: Oilseeds and Products, Grain and Feed, Fishery Products, Livestock and Products

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Report Highlights:

Cambodia's imports of soybean meal (SBM) and dried distillers grains (DDGs) in 2024 increased 6 percent year-on-year to 173 thousand metric tons (TMT), equivalent to 9 percent of Cambodia's actual feed production. The United States and Argentina remain top suppliers of DDGs and SBM, respectively. Growth in gross domestic product (GDP), higher demand for protein intake, and efforts in reducing pressure on natural fisheries continue to support expansion in aquaculture, commercial swine and poultry farms, offering opportunities for feed ingredients, including SBM and DDGs.

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Overview

The Kingdom of Cambodia, home to approximately 17.8 million people, is a country in Southeast Asia on the south of the Indochina peninsula. It's bordered by Vietnam to the east, Laos Republic to the north, Thailand to the northwest, and the Gulf of Thailand to the southwest. According to the World Bank, Cambodia reached lower middle-income status in 2015 and aims to attain upper middle-income country status by 2030 and high-income country status by 2050. The country's nominal GDP (current US\$) in 2023 was estimated at \$42.3 billion, up 5 percent year-on-year, mainly boosted by garment and agricultural exports, tourism and foreign investments¹. GDP in 2024 is projected to grow by around 6 percent, according to Cambodia's Economy and Finance Ministry.

Agriculture alone contributed 22 percent of Cambodia's GDP in 2023, according to Cambodia's Minister of Agriculture, Forestry and Fisheries (MAFF). Crop production (mostly rice)², fisheries, livestock and forestry are the four pillars driving agricultural growth in Cambodia. Additional information about crop production can be found in the feed and feed ingredient production section below.

Aquaculture

Fish is central to Cambodia's diet, culture, economy, and food security, with consumption per capita at one of the highest per capita fish consumption rates globally³. Fish provides 76 percent of household protein intake and is the second-most-consumed food after rice, according to the WorldFish organization. The fish supply in Cambodia is comprised of freshwater fish, mostly caught on the Mekong River and Tonle Sap Lake, seafood from the Gulf of Thailand Sea, and aquaculture.

¹ World Bank's data

² More about Cambodia's rice sector is available at GAIN report [CB2024-0001](#) and [CB2024-0004](#)

³ World Population Review: Cambodia's fish per capita consumption: 41 kgs per year

Cambodia was previously known as the “Kingdom of Fish”, but its natural fish resources have decreased every year. To meet rising market demand, Cambodia has imported fish, mostly from Vietnam and invested in aquaculture. The growth of fish farming presents an opportunity for feed ingredients including those of U.S. origin.

The Government of Cambodia has committed to reducing pressures on natural fisheries by advancing aquaculture practices and promoting proper fish farming, breeding, and feed quality improvements. Cambodia’s aquaculture has received support from numerous international organizations, including WorldFish, Food and Agriculture Organization of the United Nations (FAO), EU and USDA. Freshwater fish farmed in ponds, cages and rice fields have dominated production. According to the Fisheries Administration, Cambodia’s aquaculture production in 2024 is estimated to slightly increase by 2 percent to 320,000 tons, accounting for nearly 35 percent of the country’s total fish supply. The Ministry of Agriculture Forestry and Fisheries is encouraging producers to adopt and become certified for “Good Aquaculture Practices” which requires use of pellet fish feed.

Swine and poultry

According to MAFF, demand for meat consumption in Cambodia increased by 14 percent between 2019 and 2023, to roughly 327,000 metric tons (MT), including 91,000 MT of beef and buffalo, 165,000 MT of pork, 70,000 MT of poultry, and 1,000 MT of other meat. Local livestock could meet 98 percent of the total market demand.

While cattle and buffalo are dominated by households, swine and poultry herds are being raised by both households and commercial entities. According to Cambodia’s General Department for Animal Health and Production (GDAHP), swine and poultry production in 2024 totaled roughly 4 million and 62 million heads, respectively, of which commercial swine and poultry farming grew at much higher paces than household farming (see Table 1, chart 1 and chart 2).

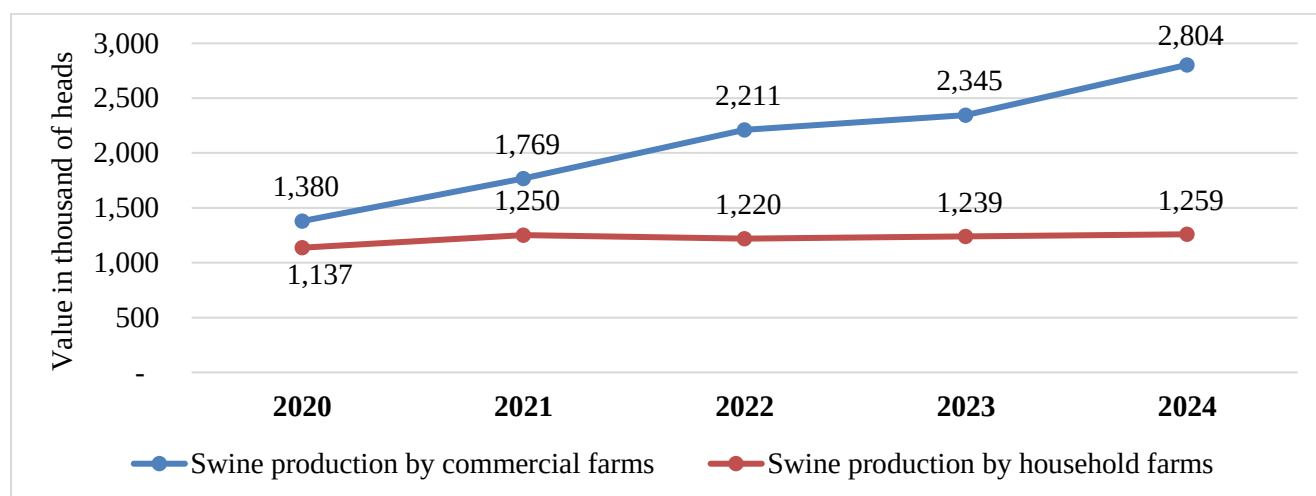
Table 1: Swine and Poultry Population in Cambodia

Species	2020	2021	2022	2023	2024	CAGR ⁴
Pigs (thousand heads)	2,517	3,019	3,431	3,584	4,063	10%
Annual change (%)	15%	20%	14%	4%	13%	
Poultry (thousand heads)	48,062	53,423	58,154	59,351	61,554	5%
Annual change (%)	19%	11%	9%	2%	4%	

Source: Cambodia’s General Department for Animal Health and Production of Cambodia’s

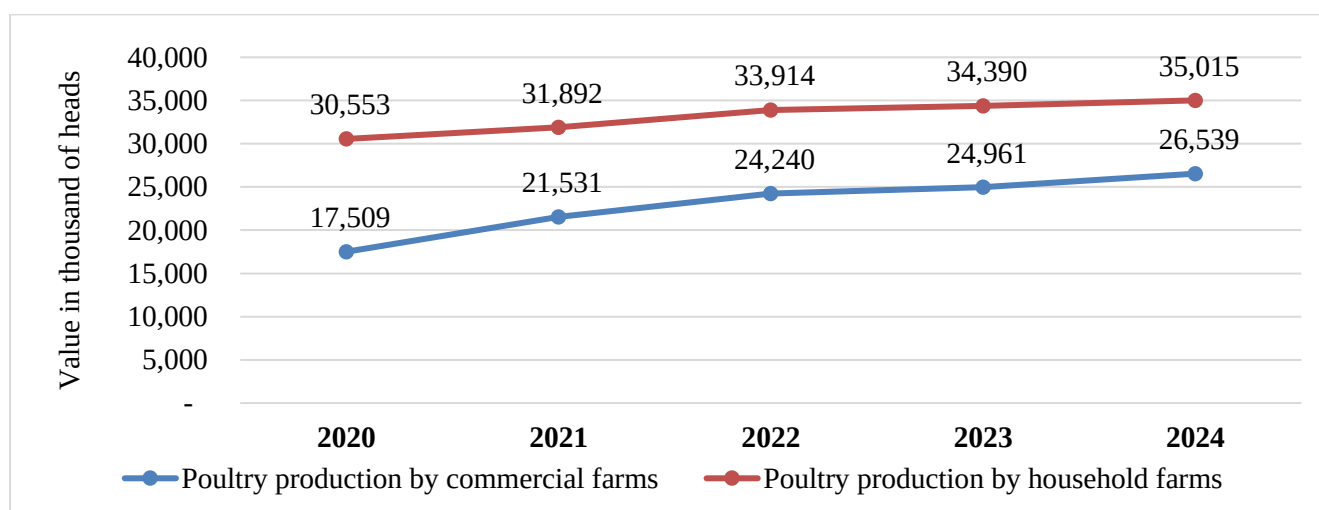
⁴ Compound Annual Growth Rate

Chart 1: Swine production by household farms vs commercial farms



Source: Cambodia's General Department for Animal Health and Production

Chart 2: Poultry production by household farms vs commercial farms



Source: Cambodia's General Department for Animal Health and Production

In short, continued growth in gross domestic product (GDP), higher demand for protein intake, and ongoing efforts in reducing pressure on natural fisheries continue to support expansion in aquaculture, commercial swine and poultry farms, offering opportunities for feed ingredients, including SBM and DDGs.

Feed and feed ingredient production

Animal feed production has also spiked over the years corresponding with the expansion of aquaculture, commercial swine and poultry farms. According to GDAHP, there were about 30 industrial animal feed mills operating in Cambodia with a total designed capacity of 3.5 million metric tons (MMT) as of the end of 2024. The actual production in 2024 was estimated at 1.9 MMT, up 18 percent year-on-year, and accounted for just 54 percent of the total designed capacity (see Appendix 1).

In 2024, Cambodia harvested nearly 13 MMT of paddy rice, 15.6 MMT of fresh cassava and 1 MMT of fresh corn⁵, and approximately 50 TMT of soybean⁶, providing a significant volume of ingredients to the animal feed industry. However, the Kingdom also imports a variety of ingredients, including SBM and DDGs, to meet rising demand for high animal protein formulas.

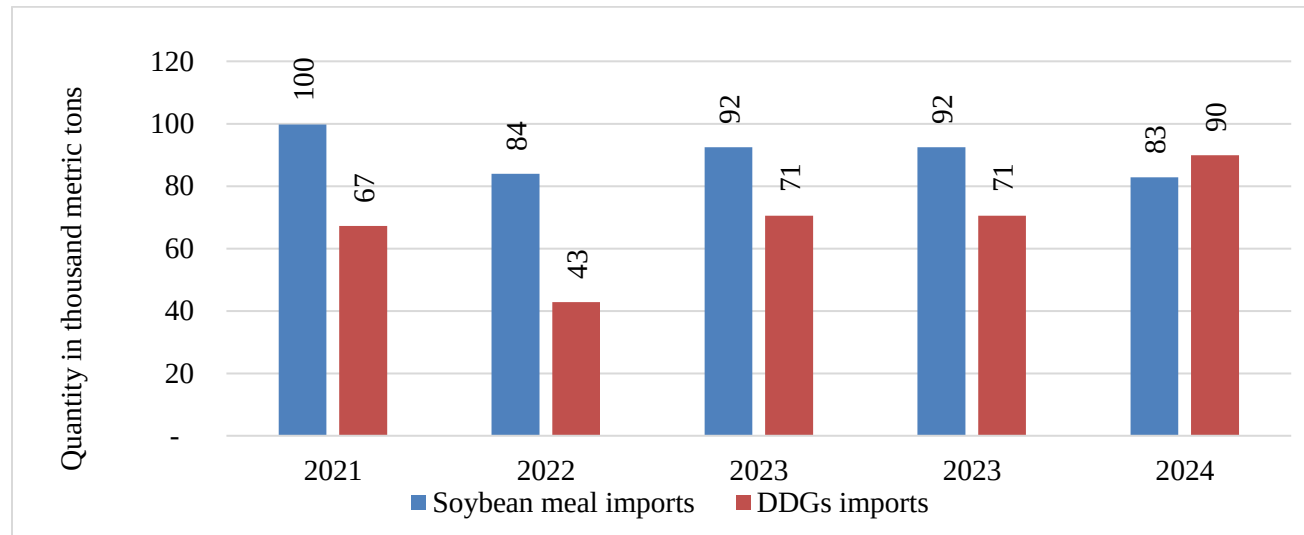
Cambodia's SBM and DDGs imports in 2024 totaled 173 thousand metric tons (TMT), up 6 percent over 2023, in which DDGs imports went up 27 percent to 90 TMT, but SBM imports contracted 10 percent to 83 TMT (Chart 3). This amount was equivalent to 9 percent of the above-mentioned 1.9 MMT of animal feed production. Post assumes that feed mills would prioritize using local ingredients available in the market.

The United States is the largest DDGs supplier while Argentina tops the SBM exporters list (Chart 4 and 5). Vietnam is likely a transit country rather than an actual exporter.

⁵ GDAHP

⁶ Post's estimate based on Food and Agricultural Organization Corporate Statistical Database.

Chart 3: Cambodia's imports of SBM and DDGs



Source: Trade Data Monitor LLC

Chart 4: SBM market share in 2024

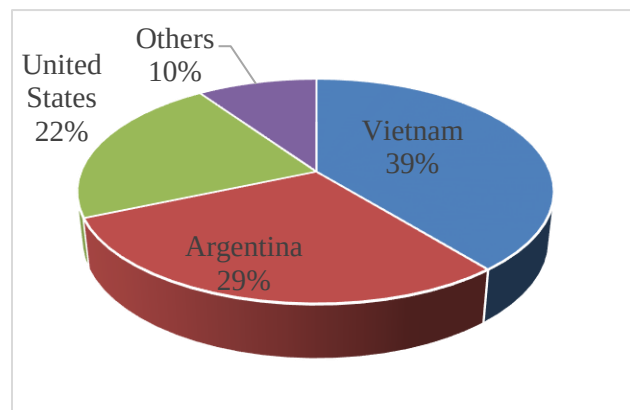
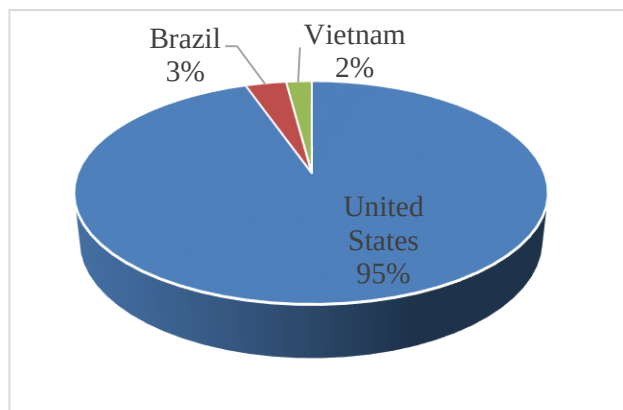


Chart 5: DDGs market share in 2024



Source: Trade Data Monitor LLC

Transportation

Although there has been recent infrastructure investment, transportation can present a challenge in Cambodia with ports and roads inefficient and costly to transport commodities in bulk, including SBM and DDGs.

Sihanoukville Autonomous Port (SAP) is the sole international deep seaport in Cambodia. SAP has been enlarged with a new 253-meter container terminal at an investment of \$37.5 million. The new terminal has an annual handling capacity of 450,000 TEU (Twenty-foot Equivalent

Unit), raising the port's total capacity to 1 million TEU per year. The terminal can accommodate vessels with drafts of up to 10.4 meters (from 35,000 to 50,000 deadweight tonnage – DWT).

Industry contacts reported that DDGs are shipped in containers while SBM is in bulk. DDGs shipments could go directly to the PAS or transit at Phu My Port in Vietnam. However, the cost for a truck carrying a container from the PAS to feed mills, many of which are near Phnom Penh, is generally more expensive than by barge from Vietnam's port to Phnom Penh. Meanwhile, SBM shipped in bulk on large vessels usually stops at Phu My Port in Vietnam, split into smaller quantity, loaded onto small boats or barges and moved on the Mekong River to feed mills in Cambodia.

Complex regulations

The Cambodian government tends to impose policies without consultation with the private sector, making it difficult for businesses to easily adjust. For further information on Cambodia's regulations relating to agriculture, please see the FAIRS reports [CB2024-0005](#) and [CB2024-0006](#).

Attachments:

No Attachments.